

Artie Ficial

Executive Director of the Meridian Museum

Artie treats the gala like a state visit and the coat check like a diplomatic incident. Polished, ambitious, and almost unnervingly composed, Artie has spent the last six years turning the Meridian from a respected regional institution into a museum that expects to be mentioned in the same sentence as the Met. He can greet a donor, calm a curator, and redirect a disaster without changing facial expression. Tonight is his biggest gala yet, and he intends for it to look effortless.

- Works closely with Claire O'Scuro, though the two disagree about how much spectacle a museum should tolerate.
- Relies on Monet Bags for the numbers and Sue Venir for donor agreements.
- Anya Tique hired Artie years ago and still occasionally speaks to him as if he were an intern.

ACTING TIPS

Diplomatic under pressure; image-conscious; dryly funny; allergic to public chaos. Play him as someone who is always hosting, even when he is not technically the host.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Black tie or an immaculate dark suit; a very official-looking gala program. Optional pocket square, tasteful lapel pin, slim folder or program.